differences; how much vaster must be the difference between an Englishman and an Asiatic?

Recently the House of Lords has been debating the question of Indian reform, and many illuminating speeches were delivered by noble lords. Among these was one by Lord Lytton, a former Governor of an Indian Province, who acted as Viceroy for a while. He has often been referred to as a liberal and sympathetic Governor. He is reported to have said[1] that "the Government of India was far more representative of India as a whole than the Congress politicians. The Government of India was able to speak in the name of officials, the Army, the Police, the Princes, the fighting regiments and both Moslems and Hindus, whereas the Congress politicians could not even speak on behalf of one of the great Indian communities." He went on to make his meaning quite clear: "When I speak of Indian opinion I am thinking of those on whose co-operation I had to rely and on whose co-operation the future Governors and Viceroys will have to rely."

Two interesting points emerge from his speech: the India that counts means those who help the British; and the British Government of India is the most representative and, therefore, democratic body in the country. That this argument should be advanced seriously shows that English words seem to change their meanings when they cross the Suez Canal. The next and obvious step in reasoning would be, that autocratic government is the most representative and democratic form because the King represents everybody. We get back to the divine right of kings and "*l'état, c'est moi!*"

As a matter of fact, even pure autocracy has had a distinguished advocate recently. Sir Malcolm Hailey, that ornament of the Indian Civil Service, speaking as Governor of the United Provinces at Benares on November 5, 1934, pleaded for autocracy in the Indian States. The advice was hardly needed, for no Indian State is at all likely to part with autocracy of its own free will. An interesting development has been the attempt to preserve this autocracy on the plea that democracy is failing in Europe. Sir Mirza Ismail, the Dewan of Mysore, has expressed his "surprise that radical reforms are advocated when parliamentary democracy is decaying everywhere." "I am sure the conscience of the State feels that our present constitution is quite democratic enough for all practical purposes."[2] The 'conscience' of Mysore presumably is a metaphysical abstraction for

[1] House of Lords, December 17, 1934.

[2] Mysore: June 21, 1934. See also note on page 530, *post*.